

Eye In-Painting with Exemplar Generative Adversarial Networks

Dolhansky, Brian, and Cristian Canton Ferrer, "*Proceedings of the IEEE conference on computer vision and pattern recognition*", 2018.

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Overview

Challenge:

- Traditional in-painting lacks **identity preservation**
E.g: Generated eyes may not match the person's true eye shape/color).
- Humans are sensitive to facial inconsistencies ("uncanny valley").
- **One possible Solution:** ExGANs use **exemplar images/codes** to guide in-painting.

Key Idea:

- **Conditional GAN** variant leveraging exemplar data (reference images or perceptual codes).
- Two Variants
 - **Reference image based ExGANs:** Use a second image of the same person as guidance.
 - **Perceptual code based ExGANs:** compressed perceptual code (vector) from a reference image to capture identity traits.

Architecture

Generator:

1. **Exemplar Encoder:** U-Net trained end to end as autoencoder
2. U-Net encoder layer later used for generating codes
3. Generated codes are concatenated with the convolved input inputs to generate the inpainted image

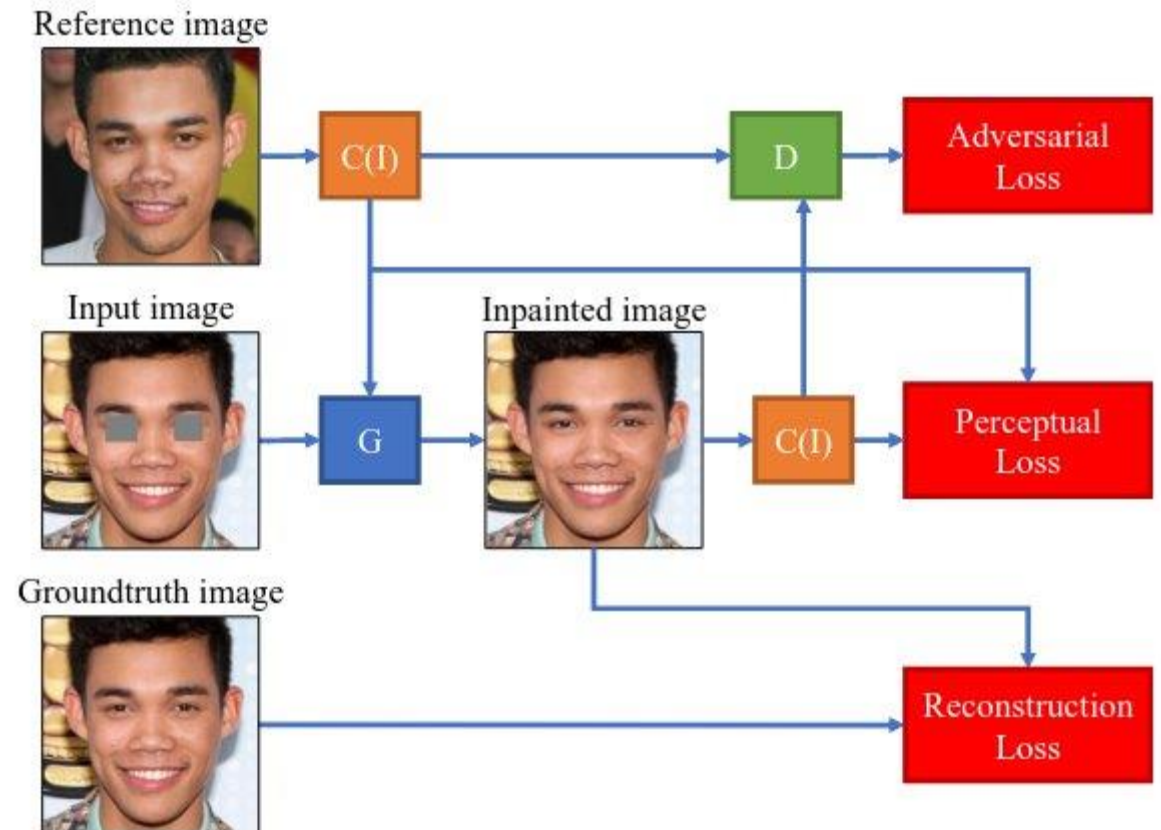
Discriminator: Dual-branch

1. Global: Evaluates full-face realism.
2. Local: Focuses on eye regions.

Loss Functions:

1. Adversarial Loss: Standard GAN min-max game.
2. Reconstruction Loss: $\|G(z_i, r_i) - x_i\|_1$
3. Perceptual Loss: Matches features in VGG space (optional).

$$\min_G \max_D V(D, G) = \mathbb{E}[\log D(x_i, r_i)] + \mathbb{E}[\log(1 - D(G(z_i, r_i)))] + L1$$



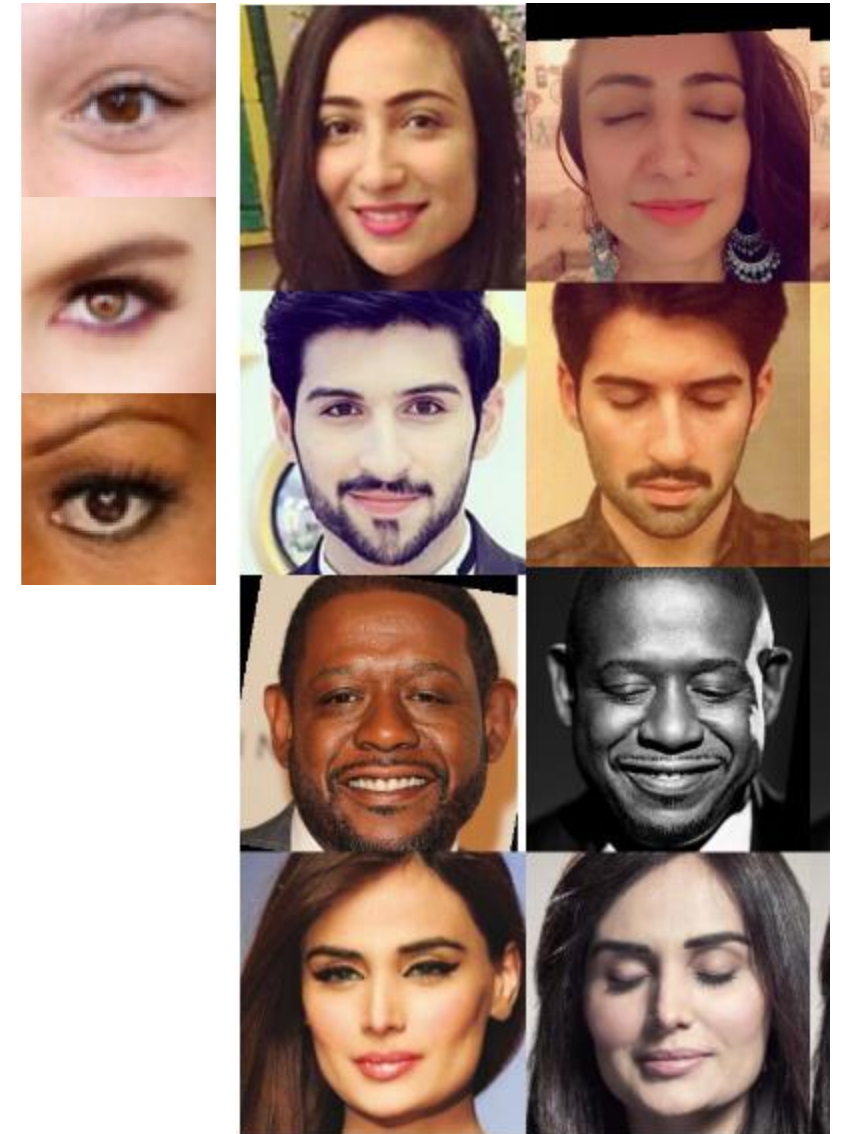
Dataset and Training

Dataset:

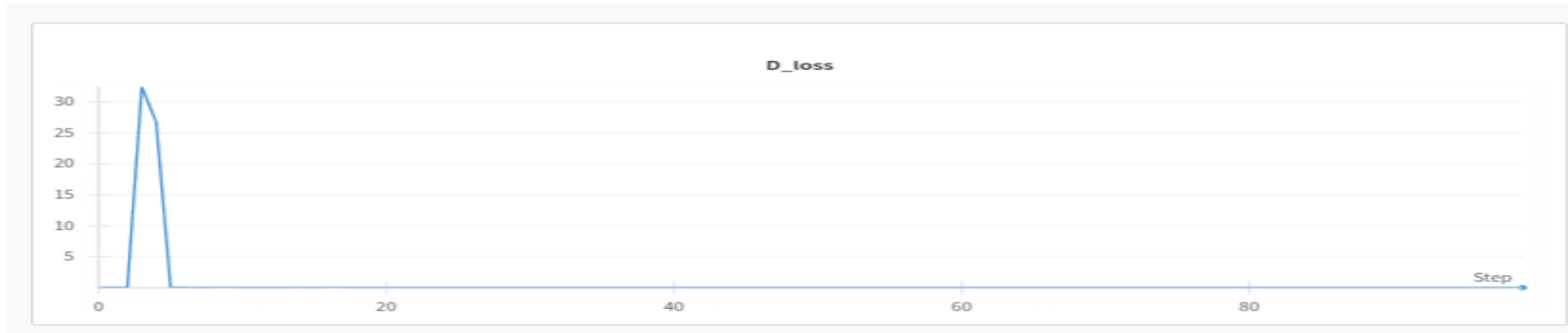
- Pairs of images (original + reference eyes) from celebrity photos.
- High resolution, varied lighting/poses.
- 2M image pairs

Training:

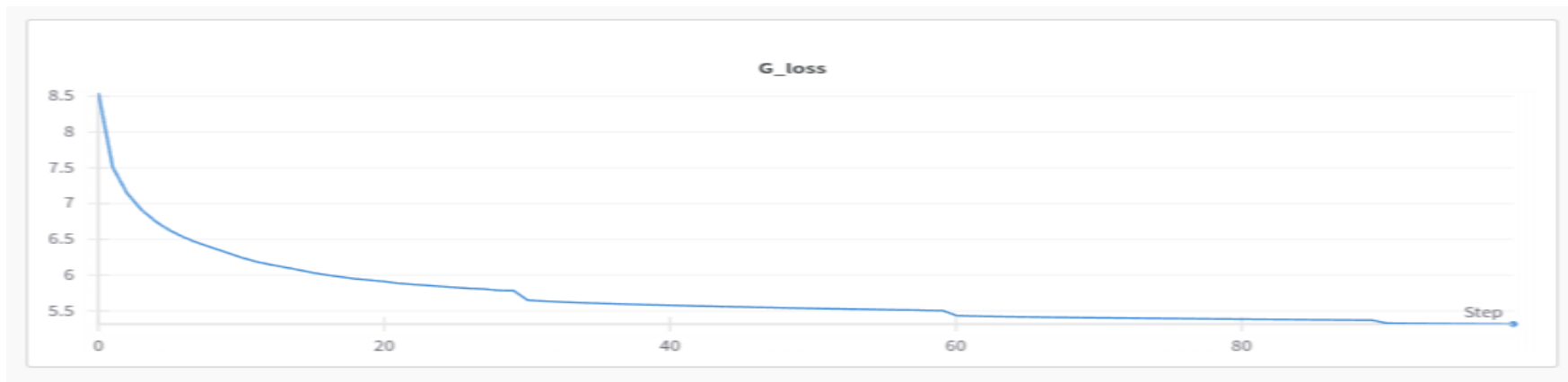
- Subsampled to 50K pairs
- Pretrained VGG for code generation
- Adam optimizer with $lr=0.0002$ and $\beta_1=0.5$, $\beta_2=0.999$, $weight_decay=1e-4$
- Scheduler: LR with $step_size=30$ and $\gamma=0.5$
- Trained for 100 epochs. Took 2 days on 1 NVIDIA RTX A6000 (48GB)



Loss



Discriminator Loss



Generator Loss

Generator

```
class ExGAN(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, z_dim=128, img_channels=3):
        super(ExGAN, self).__init__()
        self.generator = ExGANGenerator(img_channels=3, feature_channels=512)
        self.discriminator = ExGANDiscriminator(feature_channels=512)
        self.feature_extractor = FeatureExtractor()

        # Freeze feature extractor
        for param in self.feature_extractor.parameters():
            param.requires_grad = False

    def forward(self, z, exemplar_img):
        # Extract features from exemplar
        exemplar_features = self.feature_extractor(exemplar_img)

        # Generate image
        generated_img = self.generator(z, exemplar_features)
        generated_img_exemplar_features = self.feature_extractor(generated_img)
        return exemplar_features, generated_img, generated_img_exemplar_features
```

Discriminator

```
d_loss = losses.compute_adversarial_loss(exgan.discriminator, exemplar_features, fake_imgs_exemplar_features)
```

```
def compute_adversarial_loss(
    self, discriminator, exemplar_features, fake_imgs_exemplar_features
):
    """Standard GAN adversarial loss"""
    batch_size = exemplar_features.size(0)

    # Real images loss
    pred_real = discriminator(exemplar_features)
    real_labels = torch.ones(batch_size, 1, device=self.device)
    loss_real = self.adversarial_loss(pred_real, real_labels)

    # Fake images loss
    pred_fake = discriminator(fake_imgs_exemplar_features.detach())
    fake_labels = torch.zeros(batch_size, 1, device=self.device)
    loss_fake = self.adversarial_loss(pred_fake, fake_labels)

    # Total discriminator loss
    d_loss = (loss_real + loss_fake) * 0.5

    return d_loss
```

Training loop

```
for epoch in range(num_epochs):
    D_epoch_losses = []
    G_epoch_losses = []
    for real_imgs, masked_imgs, exemplar_imgs in dataloader:
        real_imgs = real_imgs.to(device)
        masked_imgs = masked_imgs.to(device)
        exemplar_imgs = exemplar_imgs.to(device)

        # Generate fake images
        exemplar_features, fake_imgs, fake_imgs_exemplar_features = exgan(
            masked_imgs, exemplar_imgs
        )
        # Update discriminator
        optimizer_d.zero_grad()
        d_loss = losses.compute_adversarial_loss(
            exgan.discriminator, exemplar_features, fake_imgs_exemplar_features
        )

        d_loss.backward()
        optimizer_d.step()

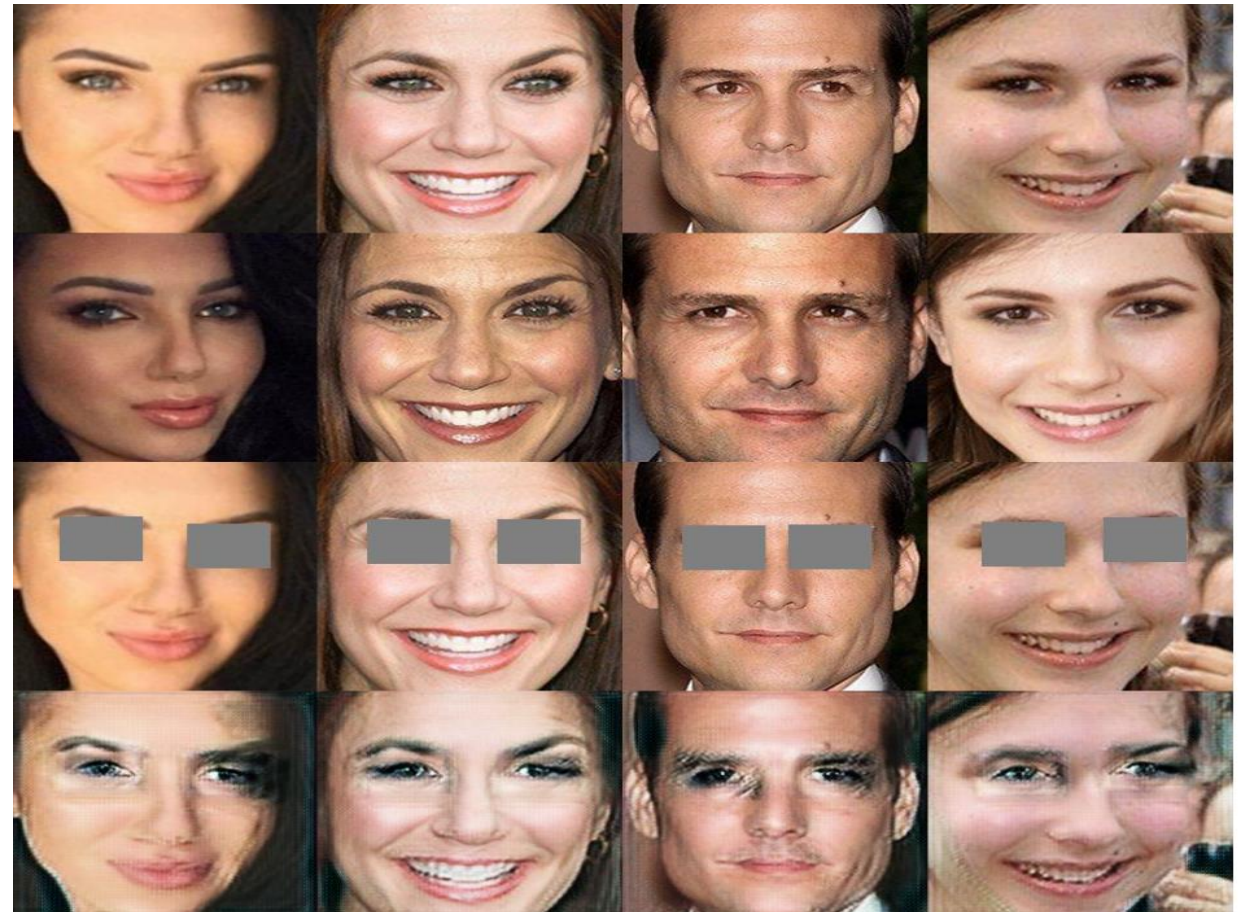
        # Update generator
        optimizer_g.zero_grad()
        g_losses = losses.compute_perceptual_loss(
            exemplar_features, fake_imgs_exemplar_features
        )
        r_losses = losses.compute_reconstruction_loss(fake_imgs, real_imgs)
        g_losses = g_losses + r_losses
        g_losses.backward()
        optimizer_g.step()
```


Results

Step: 400

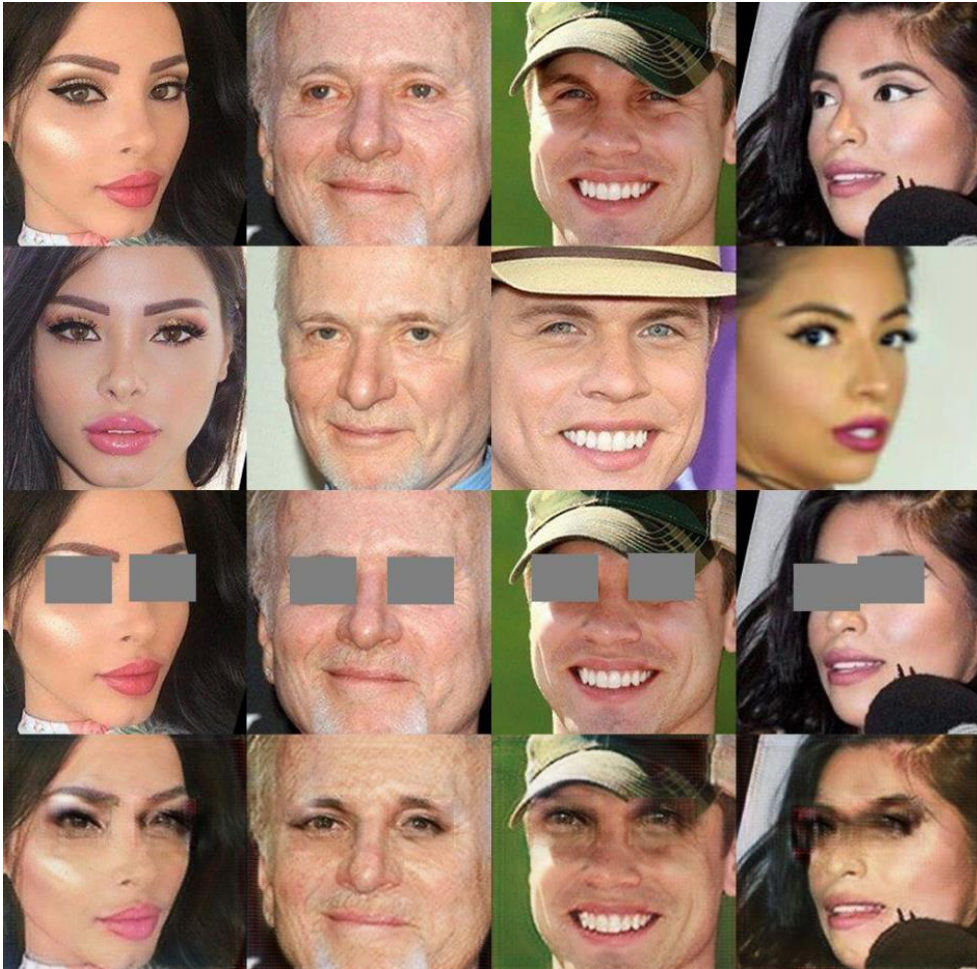


Step: 2000

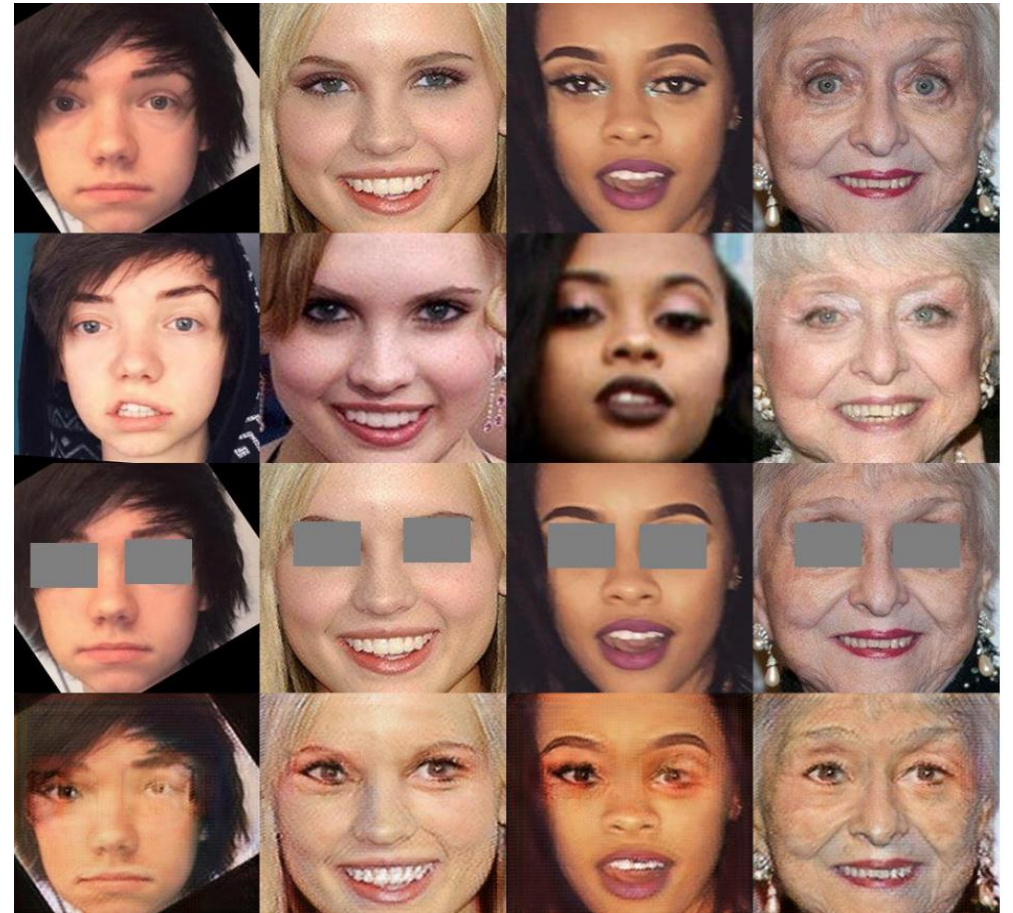


Results

Step: 4000



Step: 5600



Conclusion

Applications

- **Photo Editing:** Fix closed/blurred eyes in portraits.
- **VR/AR:** Generate realistic avatars from reference photos.
- **Medical Imaging:** In-paint missing regions in scans while preserving patient-specific features.

Challenges:

- **Dataset:** Square masks limit context
- **Training:** iris color mismatches
- **Ethics:** Potential misuse for deepfakes